November 2, 2026





NOV 2, 2026

Biobank Working Group

Agenda

- 12:00-12:05 Updates
  - Working Group was highlighted in AZA's newsletter, "It's In Our Nature"
  - IMLS grant
- 12:05-12:15 Review of where we're at
- 12:15-12:20 Actions presentation
- 12:20-1:25 Development of actions in breakouts
- 1:25-1:30 Wrap-up



Vision

Issues

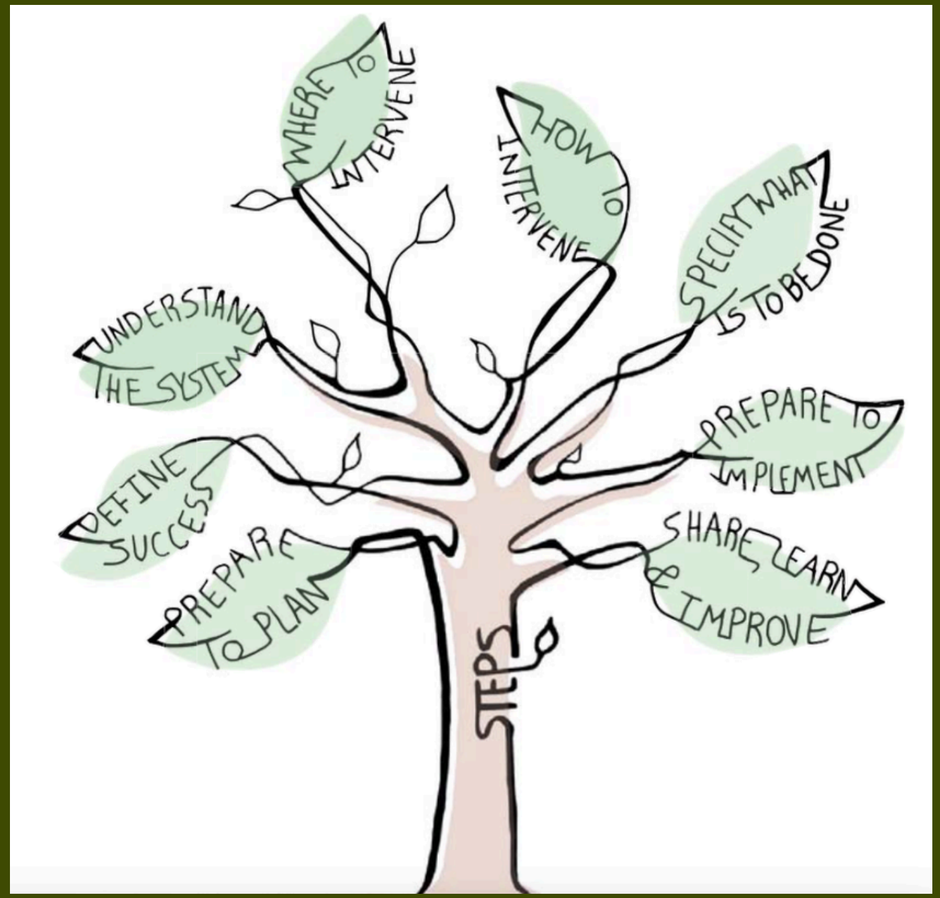
Goals

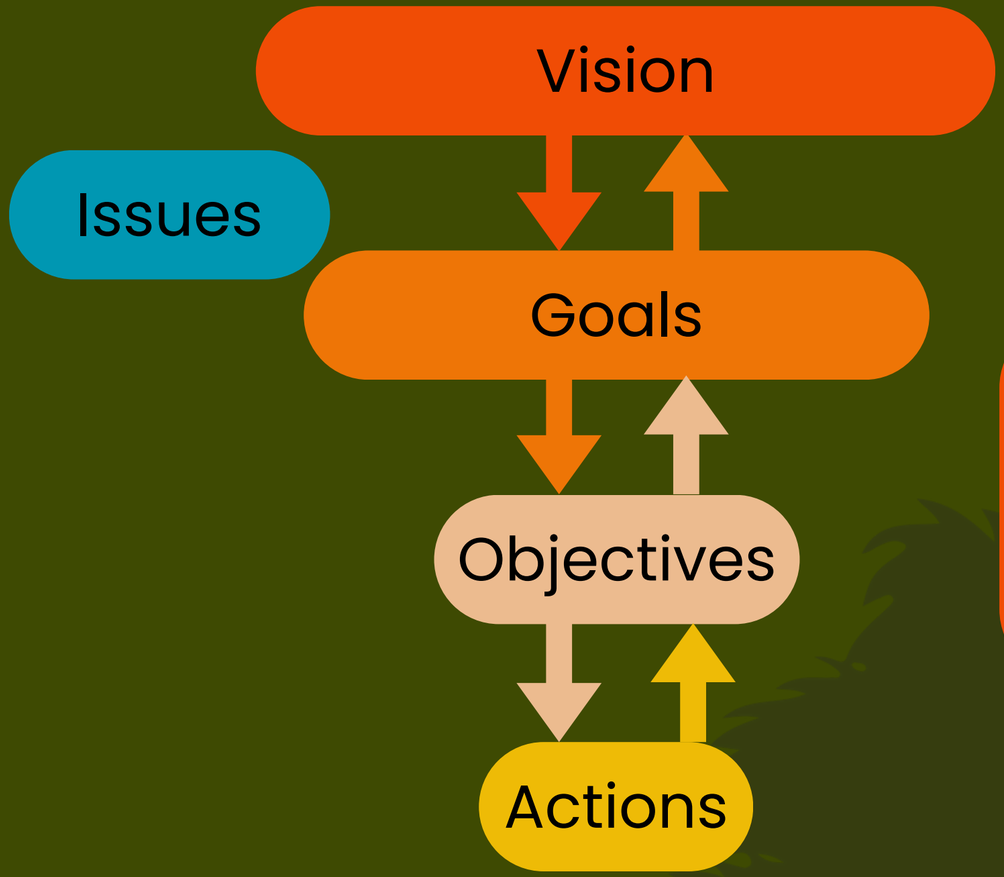
Objectives

Actions

CONSERVATION PLANNING SPECIALIST GROUP

Changing the Future for Wildlife





By 2055, biological specimens and associated data from biodiversity institutions are mobilized seamlessly at scale—driving discovery, strengthening resilient populations, and safeguarding species through fully integrated *ex situ* and *in situ* conservation and research.

By 2032, a standardized biobanking framework is in use by participating zoos and aquariums.

- By 2027, the Biobank Alliance Working Group has defined a consensus-based framework for community standards of practice.
- By 2028, operational standards of practice have been generated.
- By 2031, the biobanking framework has been piloted and evaluated by institutions participating in the Biobank Alliance.
- By 2032, a plan for scalability and recruitment for the refined biobanking framework is in place.

By 2032, biological samples and associated data from across participating zoological and aquarium institutions are seamlessly *discoverable* for the global advancement of non-commercial research and conservation.

- By 2028, participating institutions have a designated point of contact for inquiries about their sample collection in a public, globally searchable directory.
- By 2029, have defined what the searchable discoverability system is and what it looks like.
- By 2030, participating institutions have entered samples of a shared target taxon into a public database.
- By 2030, participating institutions have begun beta testing search functionality with participating institutions and select research partners.
- By 2031, a beta version of a searchable database can be used by participating institutions to add samples and associated data records.

By 2032, biological samples and associated data from across participating zoological and aquarium institutions are *accessible* from the Biobank Alliance.

- By 2028, have developed mutually agreed upon predefined conditions for accessing biobanked samples.
- By 2029, have developed a central request process through the Biobank Alliance.
- By 2030, have an established review and approval process through the Biobank Alliance.
- By 2031, a system has been implemented by five institutions for the pre-defined criteria, such that researchers can access samples through that system.

Specify what is to be done

There's a **S.M.A.R.T. way** (Doran, 1981)

	ACRONYM	DEFINITION	VARIATIONS
S	**Specific**	Target a specific area for improvement	**Strategic**
M	**Measurable**	Quantify/suggest indicator of progress	**Motivating**
A	**Assignable**	Specified to a person to deliver	**Agreed, Attainable, Action-oriented, Ambitious, Aligned with corporate goals**
R	**Realistic**	Realistic in terms of resources available	**Resourced, Reasonable, Results-based, Relevant**
T	**Time-related**	Restricted to a date when results will be achieved	**Trackable, Time-limited, Testable**

Specify what is to be done

Action	Who	When	How	Budget	Indicator of success	Priority
GOAL 1: By 2032, a standardized biobanking framework is available for use by participating zoos and aquariums.						
Objective 1.1 By 2027, the Biobank Alliance Working Group has defined a consensus-based framework for community standards of practice.						
1.1.1						NA
1.1.2						NA
1.1.3						NA
1.1.4						NA
1.1.5						NA
Objective 1.2 By 2028, operational standards of practice have been generated.						
1.2.1						NA
1.2.2						NA
1.2.3						NA
1.2.4						NA
1.2.5						NA
Objective 1.3 By 2031, the biobanking framework has been piloted and evaluated by institutions participating in the Biobank Alliance.						
1.3.1						NA
1.3.2						NA
1.3.3						NA
1.3.4						NA
1.3.5						NA
Objective 1.4 By 2032, a plan for scalability and recruitment for the refined biobanking framework is in place.						NA
1.4.1						NA
1.4.2						NA
1.4.3						NA
1.4.4						NA
1.4.5						NA

Wrap-up

- Homework
  - Meet once to finalize actions
- Next meeting: Monday, December 9

